

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

How to succeed in a job interview!



Learning Outcome

Describe ways of solving problems and getting things done in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What mistakes do people usually make in job interviews?
- How can these mistakes be corrected?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about events and experiences related to jobs.
- I can talk about facts and courses of actions.
- I can participate in interviews.





Let's Explore!

So, tell me a bit about your work experience ...



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

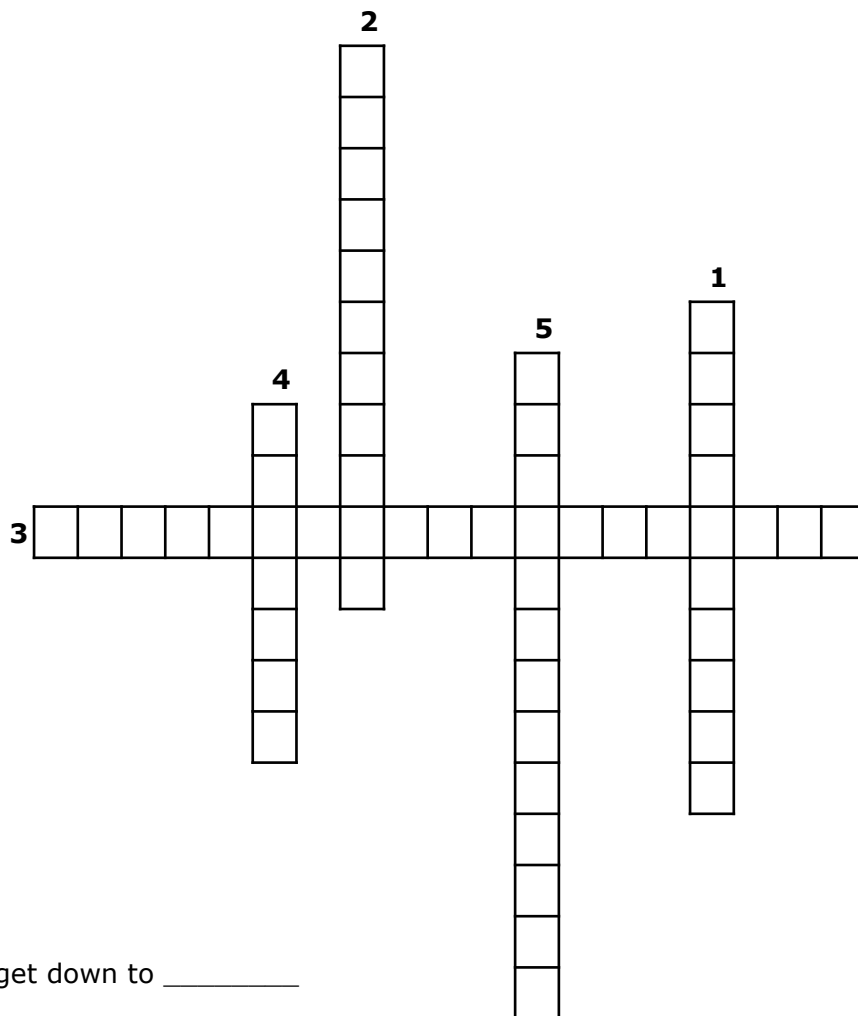
- Boris:** Thank you for coming in, Ms. Lenard. My name is Boris Brody. Did you have any trouble finding the office?
- Kristi:** Not at all. It's nice to meet you, Mr. Brody.
- Boris:** You too, Ms. Lenard. Please, take a seat.
- Kristi:** Thank you. You have a lovely office.
- Boris:** Thanks. Alright, let's get down to brass tacks. Please, tell me a little bit about yourself, Kristi.
- Kristi:** I graduated from the English program at Harvard University. I took a variety of courses to ensure I developed the skills I needed in addition to gaining a plethora of knowledge.
- Boris:** Great. What were some of the courses you took?
- Kristi:** I took a few literature courses, writing and creative writing. I also took quite a few courses in publishing.
- Boris:** Uh huh.
- Kristi:** I also took some courses that were more hands-on and I am familiar with many of the leading software packages, particularly *inPrint*.
- Boris:** We use *inPrint* for layout here too.
- Kristi:** And, in my internship at Polygon, I got to apply many of these skills.
- Boris:** Good. So in what ways did you benefit from that experience?
- Kristi:** Well, even though my responsibilities as an intern were limited, it was a great opportunity to participate and work with a team of professionals. Occasionally there was a crisis and I had to meet deadlines and deal with heavy workloads.
- Boris:** I see.
- Kristi:** I also had a good working relationship with my boss. We quickly established a good rapport.
- Boris:** That gives me a good idea of your experience. Let's move on.



Let's Practice!

Let's get down to business!

Instructions: Find the missing words for each sentence in the word search below.

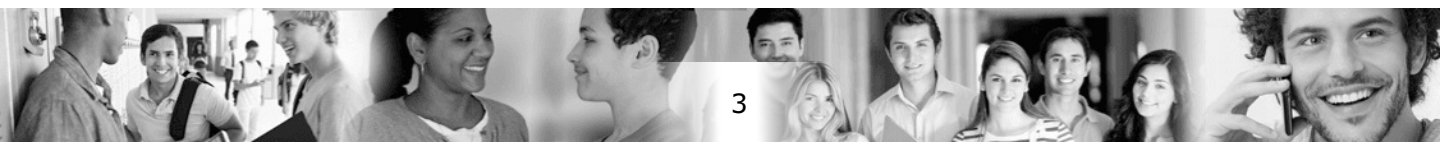


Down

1. Alright, let's get down to _____.
2. My boss and I quickly established a _____.
4. My professor got me to take some courses that were more _____.
5. Occasionally, there was a crisis and my boss had me help _____.

Across

3. I had a good _____ with my boss.



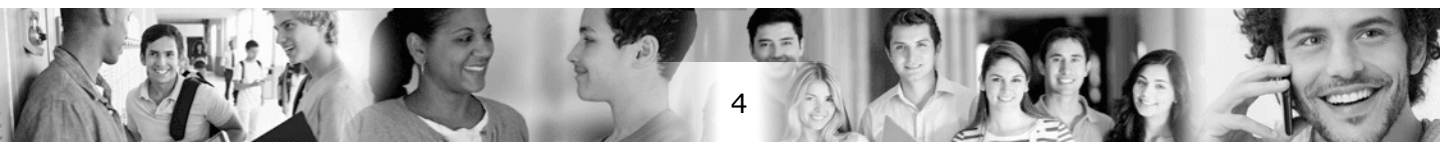


Let's Practice!

What Kristi did at her interview was ...

Instructions: Select the correct answer. Practice saying the complete sentences aloud with your partner. Correct each other.

1. Now _____ we are looking for is an editorial assistant.
 - a. what
 - b. when
 - c. which
2. I have your letter of reference from your former editor and what she has _____ is very complementary.
 - a. saying
 - b. to say
 - c. say
3. _____ I hoped to achieve by doing that was to ensure that I developed the skills I needed.
 - a. Why
 - b. What
 - c. Where
4. Tell me about some of the courses you took and in _____ way do they apply to the position?
 - a. that
 - b. what
 - c. which
5. So in what ways _____ you benefit from that experience?
 - a. does
 - b. did
 - c. do





Extension Activity

The "dos" and "don'ts" of a job interview!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- With a partner, brainstorm all the things people should do in an interview and all the things people shouldn't do.
- Establish which are the most important.
- Make a poster for the wall with pictures of job interview "dos" and job interview "don'ts."
- Get your pictures from the Internet or magazines and make a collage.
- Display the posters around the room.
- With your partner, make a short presentation explaining your poster.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I brainstorm proper interview etiquette.

☐ ☐

I make a poster displaying my ideas in a creative concept.

☐ ☐

I explain why I think certain "dos" and "don'ts" are very important.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **get down to brass tacks** (expression): get to the point quickly
e.g. Alright, let's get down to brass tacks.
- **established a good rapport** (expression): worked together on friendly terms
e.g. My boss and I quickly established a good rapport.
- **working relationship** (expression): the way two people work together
e.g. I had a good working relationship with my boss.
- **hands-on** (expression): practical; not theoretical
e.g. My professor got me to take some courses that were more hands-on.
- **meet deadlines** (expression): complete work at the expected time
e.g. Occasionally, there was a crisis and I had to meet deadlines.





Learning Points

Causatives *Get* and *Have*

We use a causative verb when we want to talk about something that someone else did for us. It means that the subject caused the action to happen, but didn't do it themselves.

You use the causative verbs **get / have** when you want to make it clear that the subject paid, asked, or persuaded the other person to do something.

Get usually means "to convince to do something" or "to trick someone into doing something".

[get + person + to + verb]

Examples:

- *My boss **got her to work** late on Tuesday.*
- *Did the boss **get you to work** on Saturday?*

(My boss convinced these people to do something.)

[get + object + past participle]

For example:

- *I had to **get the work done** on time.*

Have

{have + object + verb} or {have + object + past participle}

Have means to give someone the responsibility to do something.

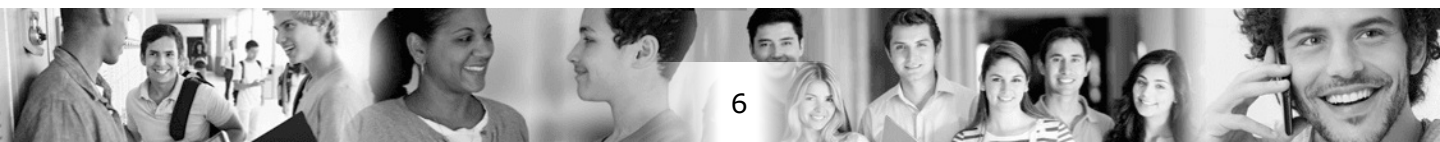
For example:

- *Dr. Smith **had his nurse take** the patient's temperature.*
- *Please **have your secretary fax** me the information.*
- *I **had the windows washed**.*

Sometimes, you use *get* when you want to convey the feeling that you need to convince someone to do something. *Have* is a little more neutral.

Examples:

- *My professor **got me to take** some courses.*
- *We **got our workers to use** inPrint for layout here too.*
- *My supervisor **had me apply** many of these skills.*
- *There was a crisis and my boss **had me help**.*





Learning Points

What-Clauses and Long Noun Phrases as Subjects

What-clauses are used to help us focus on a particular part of the sentence and to emphasise what we want to say by introducing it as a relative clause.

What-clauses are usually linked to the clause that we want to focus on with **is** or **was**.

Compare:

***What** I am looking for is a new secretary.
A new secretary is **what I** am looking for.*

***What-clauses** are often used with verbs like **adore, dislike, enjoy, hate, like, hope, love, need, prefer, and want**.*

***What** I **hate** most about going to a job interview is the waiting.
What I **liked** most about their company was the people.*

What-clauses are also often used with **does/do/did** and when we want to give emphasis to the whole sentence, rather than a particular clause.

Compare:

*The manager interviewed all the salespeople first.
What the manager **did** first **was** interview all the salespeople.*

These sentences are useful in writing where we cannot use intonation for emphasis, but they are also often used in speech.

Examples:

- *Now **what** we are looking for is an editorial assistant.*
- *I have your letter of reference from your former editor and **what** she has to say is very complementary.*
- ***What** I hoped to achieve by doing that was to ensure that I developed the skills I needed while gaining a plethora of knowledge.*

